

Fungi

Mushrooms, toadstools, yeasts, and moulds are all kinds of fungi. Fungi are neither animals nor plants. They feed on living or dead animals or plants, and absorb their nutrients.



Mushrooms

Many fungi are hidden in the soil, or inside food sources like trees. They only become visible when they grow mushrooms. Mushrooms scatter spores, which will grow into new fungi.

Picking wild mushrooms

Many wild mushrooms are not only edible, but delicious. However others are highly poisonous! Harmful mushrooms are often called toadstools. They sometimes use bright colours to warn animals not to eat them.

Wood blewit mushroom



Penny bun mushroom



Fly agaric mushroom



Jelly antler fungus



Bread mould



Warm, moist bread

Moulds

Moulds are microscopic fungi which grow in long strands called "hyphae". They feed on dead organic matter – like our food – by making it rot.



Athlete's foot

Athlete's foot is a disease caused by ringworm fungi growing on human feet. It makes the skin between your toes turn red and flaky.